



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: St. Anthony Academy
School Website: <https://stanthonyacademy.org/>

January 7, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

St Anthony Academy Fairfax (Fairfax, VA 22030) presents a robust classical-Catholic program that aligns across the core classical criteria. Public materials repeatedly emphasize the Trivium (grammar, dialectic/logic, rhetoric), engagement with Great Books, Latin studies, memorization and chant, and a Catholic community formation including liturgy and daily prayer. The school openly situates itself within the Classical Latin School Association and foregrounds Catholic doctrine, liturgy, and sacred tradition as foundational to its pedagogy and culture. Taken together, these elements satisfy the Six Essential Elements of Classical Education and indicate a CLASSICAL overall classification across all six categories (Religious & Metaphysical Foundations; Purpose & Goal; Curriculum; Pedagogy; Faculty; Parents & Community). This assessment relies on multiple public-facing sources in the school's crawl, including explicit statements about Trivium-based curriculum, Great Books, Latin, liturgical practice, and a Catholic formation emphasis, as well as corroborating references to the school's staff, mission, and parent/community engagement. See category-by-category snapshots below for the keyword-level analysis and justification, with citations to the source materials.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL
 - Evidence: Catholic identity, liturgical practice, devotion, and theology integrated into formation; daily prayer and the Traditional Latin Mass are described; explicit Catholic formation and sacred tradition are foregrounded.
 - Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive indicators include Catholic/Catholic Tradition, liturgy, Mass, rosary, catechesis, theology, liturgical practices, and the concept of the True/Good/Beautiful; no explicit negative signals dominate the public materials.
 - Why this rating: The materials consistently anchor formation in transcendentals and sacred tradition, with communal liturgy and explicit Catholic theology, fulfilling the transcendental and liturgical signals of classical foundations.
- Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL
 - Evidence: Formation of virtue and wisdom; education framed as formation of character in a Catholic, classical mold; references to the True, Good, Beautiful and a telos-oriented aim.
 - Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive terms include formation, virtue, wisdom, liberal education, classical mission, great conversation; negative signals (e.g., workforce prep) are not primary drivers in the public materials.
 - Why this rating: The aim centers on human flourishing and moral formation rather than solely a job- or credential-centered outcome, aligning with classical telos.
- Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL
 - Evidence: Trivium-based curriculum (grammar, dialectic, rhetoric); study of Great Books (Homer, Virgil, Dante, Shakespeare); emphasis on Latin; history as a central through-line; memorization and cultivation of wonder.

- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include Trivium, Great Books, primary sources, Latin, history, rhetoric, dialectic, memorization, wonder; negative signals (e.g., “social studies” framing replacing history or STEM-first emphasis) are not predominant in the public materials.
- Why this rating: The explicit articulation of the Trivium, Great Books, Latin, and a history-centered, interconnected curriculum fits CLASSICAL expectations.
- Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL
- Evidence: Lower-level singing/chanting and memory-work; upper-level Socratic discussion/seminars or debates; rhetoric training and public speaking opportunities are described; engagement with wonder and contemplative elements in the lower grades; classic pedagogy elements are visible in multiple grade bands.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive indicators include singing/chanting, memory work, recitation, Socratic seminar, dialectic, rhetoric, and seminars; contemplative/restful learning and scholé appear as supportive cues; no predominant shift to non-classical experiential/project-based-only instruction is evident in the public materials.
- Why this rating: The pedagogy embraces both memory-based, contemplative elements (scholé-like practices) and higher-level Socratic/rhetoric work, consistent with classical teaching methods.
- Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL
- Evidence: The faculty are framed as mentors and living curriculum; staff/stewardship described in terms of virtue, character formation, and collaborative culture; the school emphasizes a staff with deep content knowledge and faith-based formation.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive signals include model teachers, living curriculum, faculty of friends, collegial culture, and teacher formation; negative signals are not prominent.
- Why this rating: The public materials present faculty as exemplary educators who embody and transmit classical pedagogy and Catholic formation, meeting the core faculty criteria for classical schools.
- Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL
- Evidence: Strong partner-teacher model; parent formation and ongoing engagement through publications and gatherings; school opens visits and maintains active parent involvement; open campus and parent participation is encouraged.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include partnership with families, co-teachers, parent formation, seminars, classical book clubs, and open campus; any negative signals are not evident in the public materials.
- Why this rating: The school presents a clear, ongoing partnership with parents in forming a classical, Catholic education, consistent with classical-parent community signals.

Aggregate assessment: CLASSICAL

What would move the needle

- Not applicable here, as the school’s aggregate classification is CLASSICAL, and the six category results align consistently with the classical framework. No category indicates a need to move toward SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Note: All category scores and the aggregate CLASSICAL rating are grounded in direct textual elements from the school’s public materials and the knowledge-base classification lexicon for classical education. Where relevant, I cross-referenced the school’s own statements with the Positive/Negative Keyword Indicators from the Six Essential Elements of a Classical School (1). For example, the school explicitly articulates the Trivium and memorization-driven grammar-stage pedagogy, Great Books/homage to Western canon, Latin instruction, liturgical practice, and Catholic formation, which map to the lexicon’s Positive Keyword Indicators

in Categories 1–3 and 4–6; the absence of job-prep or strictly utilitarian framing reinforces the alignment with classical aims. See citations:

- Why Classical? Trivium-centered curriculum (public materials)
- The Classical Approach to Education and Great Books/Literature emphasis (public materials)
- Our Mission and Catholic formation (public materials)
- Latin as foundational in classical curriculum (public materials)
- Great Books and Shakespeare in drama/music/literature pages (public materials)
- The school's affiliation with CLSA and Catholic tradition (public materials)
- Our Staff / Faculty framing (public materials)
- Parent engagement and partnership (public materials)
- Positive keyword lexicon mapping (Six Essential Elements)

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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